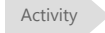


Intersection Group — EDGY 23 Enterprise Design Analysis

Source:	intersection.group website, public materials, conference information, course descriptions
Method:	EDGY 23 Enterprise Design in a Box framework
Analyst:	Claude (AI-assisted analysis)

 Identity (Purpose, Story, Content)  Architecture (Capability, Asset, Process)  Experience (Task, Channel, Journey)  Brand

 Product  Organisation

Badge shape = base element type:  Outcome rounded (Purpose, Capability, Task)  Activity arrow (Story, Process, Journey)  Object rectangle (Content, Asset, Channel, intersections)

1. Executive Summary

Intersection Group is a not-for-profit association headquartered in Vienna, Austria, founded formally in 2020 with roots tracing back to Milan Guenther's 2012 book "Intersection: How Enterprise Design Bridges the Gap between Business, Technology, and People." The organisation curates and promotes EDGY, an open-source enterprise design language, and fosters a global community of 7,000+ practitioners spanning designers, architects, advisors, executives, and researchers.

The EDGY analysis reveals strong  **Identity** —  **Architecture** coherence — Intersection's purpose of democratising enterprise design is directly realised through its open-source framework curation and community-building capabilities. However, the  **Experience** facet shows development areas: the journey from free community member to paying course participant lacks clear progression mechanics, and channel strategy relies heavily on conferences and online courses with limited always-on engagement touchpoints. The intersection elements reveal a tension between the not-for-profit mission and the need for sustainable revenue through paid offerings (€950 courses, conference tickets), creating a  **Product** —  **Identity** coherence gap that needs deliberate management.

2. Identity Facet — Why does Intersection Group exist?

Purpose

"Help people create better enterprises that dare, deliver and delight"

Intersection Group exists to bridge the gap between traditionally siloed disciplines — enterprise architecture, service design, organisational design, and strategic management — into a unified practice called Enterprise Design. The purpose is explicitly transformational: not merely providing tools, but changing how people think about and design enterprises. This positions Intersection uniquely as a discipline-builder rather than a consultancy or tool vendor, with a meta-level ambition to reshape how entire industries approach organisational transformation.

Story

"From a book to a global movement — building Enterprise Design as a discipline"

The story begins with Milan Guenther's 2012 book that coined the term "Enterprise Design" and articulated the need for interdisciplinary integration. The first Intersection Conference in 2014 brought practitioners together, creating momentum that led to the formal establishment of Intersection Group as a not-for-profit association in 2020. The release of EDGY 23 in 2023 marked a pivotal milestone — transforming conceptual thinking into a concrete, open-source toolset. Now heading toward its 12th global conference (Intersection 26 in Montreal, October 2026), the story arc follows a classic movement pattern: idea → community → institution → methodology → global adoption.

Content

"Open, interdisciplinary, and practitioner-driven communication"

Intersection's content strategy centres on openness and accessibility — EDGY is free to use, documentation is publicly available, and the community welcomes diverse perspectives. The communication tone is approachable yet intellectually rigorous, exemplified by marketing like "So easy you could play with your mom" for the EDGY toolset. Content includes blog articles, the "Enterprise Design Patterns" book (35 patterns), webinar recordings, course materials, and conference presentations. The content philosophy explicitly avoids vendor lock-in messaging and proprietary gatekeeping.

Strength: **Content** strongly expresses **Purpose** — the open-source, community-driven communication approach directly embodies the mission of helping people create better enterprises through accessible tools and shared knowledge.

□ Purpose

Democratising Enterprise Design — bridging design, architecture, and strategy into a unified discipline

▷ Story

2012 book → 2014 conference →
2020 association → 2023 EDGY
release → global movement

□ Content

Open docs, patterns book, webinars,
conference talks — approachable yet
rigorous

3. Architecture Facet — How does Intersection Group operate?

Capability

Capability	Nature	Level
Framework curation & methodology development	Differentiating, in-house	Core
Training & certification programme design	Differentiating, in-house	Core
Community building & chapter management	Differentiating, in-house	Core
Conference organisation & production	Differentiating, partially outsourced	Core
Publishing & content production	Commodity, in-house	Supporting
Digital tool vendor accreditation	Differentiating, in-house	Supporting
Partnership management (5 tracks)	Commodity, in-house	Supporting

Note: Intersection's capability portfolio is tightly focused on its core mission — four of seven capabilities are differentiating and core. The concentration of differentiating capabilities in framework curation and education is appropriate for a methodology-driven organisation. Risk lies in the dependency on a small team for framework evolution — as a not-for-profit, attracting and retaining talent for methodology R&D is challenging.

Asset

- **EDGY methodology and intellectual property** — The EDGY 23 framework, including the language specification, stencils, SVG shapes, PowerPoint templates, and documentation. Open-source but curated by Intersection, this is the organisation's primary strategic asset and the foundation of all other activities.
- **Global practitioner community (7,000+ members)** — The network of practitioners, local chapters (Montreal, Paris, Australia, Germany, UK), and the conference alumni base. This community is both a distribution channel and a co-creation resource for methodology evolution.
- **Intersection Conference brand** — 11 editions since 2014, the conference is the flagship event that anchors the community's annual rhythm and generates visibility, revenue, and practitioner engagement.
- **Training curriculum and certification system** — Structured courses (EDGY Enterprise Scan, EDGY Language Foundations) and the EDGY Practitioner certification, representing codified knowledge and a credentialing system.

Process

- **Open-source framework development** — Continuous curation and evolution of EDGY through community input, practitioner feedback, and core team refinement. Includes version management, documentation updates, and tooling

integration.

- **Cohort-based training delivery** — Structured 4–6 week online courses with scheduled cohorts, combining self-paced learning with live sessions and peer interaction. Includes assessment and certification issuance.
- **Conference production cycle** — Annual cycle of call for contributions, speaker selection, programme design, venue management, and event execution across global locations.
- **Community chapter support** — Enabling and coordinating local community chapters through shared resources, brand guidelines, and networking support.

Strength: Processes realise capabilities coherently — the open-source development process directly supports framework curation, cohort-based training delivers the education capability, and conference production enables community building. The process architecture is lean and appropriate for a not-for-profit scale.

□ **Capability: Framework Curation**

EDGY 23 language development and refinement (Core, Differentiating)

□ **Capability: Training**

Course design and practitioner certification (Core, Differentiating)

□ **Capability: Community**

7000+ practitioners, global chapters (Core, Differentiating)

□ **Asset: EDGY IP**

Framework spec, stencils, templates, documentation

□ **Asset: Community**

7000+ members in local chapters worldwide

▷ **Process: Open-Source Dev**

Community-driven framework evolution

▷ **Process: Cohort Training**

4–6 week online courses with certification

4. Experience Facet — What role does Intersection Group play in people's lives?

Task

1. **Learn Enterprise Design fundamentals** — Practitioners new to the discipline seeking to understand the EDGY framework and its application (individual practitioners, consultants)
2. **Obtain EDGY practitioner certification** — Professionals wanting to validate their enterprise design competence for career advancement or client credibility (consultants, in-house architects)
3. **Network with interdisciplinary peers** — Practitioners seeking to connect with others who work at the intersection of design, architecture, and strategy (all segments)
4. **Apply EDGY in real enterprise transformation projects** — Practitioners and enterprises needing practical guidance on using EDGY in actual engagements (enterprises, consultancies)
5. **Contribute to Enterprise Design as a discipline** — Experienced practitioners wanting to advance the field through research, pattern documentation, and community leadership (senior practitioners, academics)

Channel

Channel	Type	Role
Website (intersection.group)	Digital, asynchronous	Primary information and onboarding gateway
Online courses (cohort-based)	Digital, synchronous + asynchronous	Core learning and certification delivery
Intersection Conference	Physical, synchronous	Flagship engagement, networking, and knowledge exchange
Local chapters	Physical + digital, synchronous	Ongoing peer engagement and practice sharing
Social media & blog	Digital, asynchronous	Awareness, thought leadership, community updates
Webinars	Digital, synchronous	Topic-specific deep dives and community engagement

Journey



Strength: The journey reflects the **Purpose** well — it moves from consumption to contribution, embodying the community-driven, open philosophy. However, the transition from free exploration to paid learning (the monetisation gateway) could be smoother — the jump from free resources to €950 courses is significant without intermediate paid offerings.

□ Task: Learn

Understand EDGY framework and enterprise design fundamentals

□ Task: Certify

Validate competence as EDGY Practitioner

□ Task: Network

Connect with interdisciplinary peers globally

□ Task: Apply

Use EDGY in real transformation projects

□ Task: Contribute

Advance the discipline through research and leadership

5. Intersection Elements — Bridges Between Facets

Organisation (Identity ↔ Architecture)

Not-for-profit association with a lean global structure

Intersection Group operates as a formally registered not-for-profit association headquartered in Vienna, with a distributed global presence through local community chapters. The organisational model is deliberately light — a small core team manages framework development, training, and conference production, while community chapters operate semi-autonomously.

- *pursues* **Purpose** (democratising enterprise design through open-source tools and community)
- *has* **Capabilities** (framework curation, training, community building, conference production)
- *performs* **Processes** (open-source development, cohort training, conference cycle, chapter support)
- *builds* **Brand** (positioning Enterprise Design as a legitimate, accessible discipline)

Coherence: Good — The not-for-profit structure aligns well with the open-source, community-driven identity. However, the lean organisation creates capacity constraints — scaling training delivery, supporting more chapters, and evolving the framework simultaneously stretches a small team. The tension between mission-driven operation and financial sustainability is a structural challenge.

Product (Architecture ↔ Experience)

EDGY toolset, training courses, conference, and publications

The product portfolio spans:

- **EDGY toolset** (free) — the core methodology, stencils, templates
- **Training courses** (€950) — EDGY Enterprise Scan (4 weeks), Language Foundations (6 weeks)
- **Certification** — EDGY Practitioner credential
- **Intersection Conference** (paid) — annual flagship event
- **Publications** — "Enterprise Design Patterns" book and educational materials

- *serves customer* **Tasks** (learning, certification, networking, application, contribution)
- *features in* **Journey** stages (explore: free toolset; learn: courses; certify: credential; practice: toolset + patterns; contribute: conference)

Coherence: Good — Products cover the full customer journey from discovery to contribution. The free EDGY toolset serves the mission and creates a large funnel. However, the gap between free tools and €950 courses creates a revenue-model tension — there is no intermediate paid offering (e.g., self-paced course at €99–199, or premium community membership). The product portfolio would benefit from a "middle tier" that captures value from the large free user base.

Brand (Identity ↔ Experience)

"Enterprise Design" — an open discipline, not a proprietary methodology

Intersection positions Enterprise Design as a discipline rather than a product — comparable to how "Agile" is a movement rather than a company's offering. The EDGY brand is deliberately non-proprietary: open-source, community-owned in spirit, with the Intersection Group as steward rather than gatekeeper.

- *represents* **Purpose** (making enterprise design accessible to all)
- *evokes* **Story** (the movement from siloed disciplines to integrated enterprise design)
- *supports customer* **Tasks** (the brand signals credibility and community belonging for certified practitioners)

Coherence: Strong — The brand–experience alignment is excellent. The open, non-proprietary positioning matches the free toolset and community-driven experience. Practitioners feel they are joining a movement rather than buying a vendor product. This creates genuine loyalty and advocacy. The risk is commoditisation — if Enterprise Design becomes widely adopted, Intersection's role as steward may become less visible.

□ Organisation

Not-for-profit, Vienna HQ, global chapters — Coherence: **Good**

□ Product

EDGY toolset (free) + courses (€950) + conference + publications — Coherence: **Good**

□ Brand

Enterprise Design as open discipline, not proprietary methodology — Coherence: **Strong**

6. Strengths

1. **Purpose–Architecture coherence:** Intersection's purpose of democratising enterprise design is directly and coherently realised through its open-source framework, free toolset, and community-building capabilities. There is no gap between what the organisation says it does and how it actually operates.
2. **Unique positioning as discipline-builder:** Unlike consultancies or tool vendors, Intersection occupies a rare niche as the steward of a discipline. This is strategically defensible — you cannot easily replicate a decade-long community and the credibility that comes from creating the methodology itself.
3. **Community as a self-reinforcing asset:** The 7,000+ member community is both a distribution channel, co-creation resource, and credibility engine. Practitioners who adopt EDGY become advocates, trainers, and contributors, creating a virtuous cycle that reduces marketing costs and increases content production.
4. **Open-source strategy creating trust and adoption:** By making EDGY free and open, Intersection removes the primary barrier to adoption. This builds trust, accelerates spread, and positions paid offerings (training, certification, conferences) as value-added services rather than gatekeeping mechanisms.
5. **Journey-to-contribution model:** The customer journey explicitly culminates in contribution (speaking, writing, leading chapters), which is unusual and powerful. This converts consumers into producers, extending the organisation's reach and capability far beyond its paid team.

7. Development Areas and Gaps

7.1 Revenue model fragility (**Product** – **Identity** tension)

The not-for-profit mission combined with an open-source core product creates a structural revenue challenge. The organisation depends on three revenue streams — courses (€950), conference tickets, and partnerships — with no recurring revenue model (e.g., subscriptions, membership tiers). This makes financial planning difficult and creates vulnerability to external shocks (conference cancellations, training demand fluctuations). The absence of a mid-tier product between free tools and €950 courses means a large portion of the 7,000+ community generates no revenue.

7.2 Scalability of training and certification (**Process** – **Capability** constraint)

Cohort-based training (4–6 weeks with live sessions) is high-quality but inherently unscalable. Each cohort requires instructor time, and the small team limits the number of concurrent cohorts. The EDGY Champion programme (mentorship) adds further instructor load. Without self-paced or asynchronous training options, the organisation cannot serve demand growth without proportional team growth — problematic for a not-for-profit with limited hiring capacity.

7.3 Channel gaps in always-on engagement (**Channel** gap)

Between conferences (annual) and courses (periodic cohorts), there is limited always-on engagement infrastructure. Local chapters provide some continuity but are inconsistent in activity level. The organisation lacks a community platform (forum, Slack/Discord, practice groups) that would maintain engagement between events and courses. This creates a "feast or famine" engagement pattern where practitioners may drift away between touchpoints.

7.4 Framework evolution governance (**Process** – **Organisation** gap)

As EDGY gains adoption, the governance model for framework evolution becomes critical. Currently, the core team drives changes, but as the community grows, there is no visible open governance process (RFC process, community voting, versioning roadmap). This risks either stagnation (too slow to evolve) or fragmentation (unofficial forks and extensions). The open-source analogy suggests that a formal governance model is needed as adoption scales.

7.5 Geographic concentration risk (**Organisation** – **Channel** gap)

Despite global aspirations, active chapters are concentrated in Europe (Paris, Germany, UK, Vienna) with limited presence in North America (Montreal) and Australia. Asia, Africa, and South America are underrepresented. For a discipline that claims to help design "better enterprises" globally, this geographic concentration limits both credibility and applicability to diverse enterprise contexts.

8. Recommendations

#	Recommendation	EDGY Element	Priority
1	Introduce a mid-tier paid offering (self-paced online course at €99–199 or premium community membership) to capture value from the free user base and create recurring revenue	Product	High
2	Develop a self-paced asynchronous version of EDGY Language Foundations to complement cohort training and enable scalable delivery	Process Capability	High
3	Launch a persistent community platform (forum or Slack/Discord) with practice groups, Q&A, and case-sharing to maintain engagement between events	Channel	High
4	Establish a public framework governance process (RFC mechanism, versioning roadmap, community advisory board) for EDGY evolution	Process Organisation	Medium
5	Develop a "train the trainer" programme at scale, enabling certified practitioners to deliver EDGY training independently (licensed model)	Capability Product	Medium

6	Create regional expansion strategy targeting Asia-Pacific and Latin America with localised content and chapter seeding	Organisation Channel	Medium
7	Publish annual "State of Enterprise Design" report leveraging community data to strengthen thought leadership and brand visibility	Content Brand	Low
8	Develop digital tool vendor integration programme more actively to embed EDGY into enterprise software platforms	Product Asset	Low

9. Diagrams

The following EDGY 23 diagrams are delivered with this analysis (in draw.io format):

File	Content
intersection-all-facets.drawio	Top-level overview of all facets and intersection elements
intersection-identity.drawio	Detailed Identity facet map
intersection-architecture.drawio	Detailed Architecture facet map
intersection-experience.drawio	Detailed Experience facet map

Diagrams follow the official EDGY 23 colour palette and element shapes. Open `.drawio` files in the draw.io application or at app.diagrams.net.

Analysis based on publicly available information from intersection.group, course descriptions, conference materials, and community documentation. Internal organisational information may add depth especially to Architecture and Organisation elements.